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without justice. Afzal Alive is a symbol that appeases—and brings out the Government's shallow commitment to fighting terror. Such a regime won't name the terror either. "I could not sleep after watching the families of the Indians on TV last night. Labelling Indians as terrorists or Pakistanis as terrorists is best avoided. Terrorists are terrorists. They don't belong to any community or religion." That was our prime minister in the wake of last year's Glasgow terrorist attack, which had a Bangalore connection. (And by the way, did he lose sleep after watching Jaipur on TV?) When you say the terrorist has no religion, it is more than pseudo-philosophical political correctness. It is a lie even the terrorist won't appreciate. Today terror has a religion, and invariably it is the fantasy version of the one that, in its pure scriptural form, professes submission. Kashmir, Gaza, New York, Bali, Madrid, London,

Mumbai—all datelines of terror and by naming the religion of terror you are not denigrating the entire Muslim community. The 'I' word is a taboo in an India where your government uses secularism as a weapon of mass division.

Even national grief seems to be incapable of uniting us politically. Jaipur hasn't. It is the blame game all over again, and BJP, with its more-nationalist-than-thou attitude, is busy widening the divide. Scarred and bleeding, India cannot fight radical Islamism as long as there is no political consensus or unity. And from across the border, the apostles of jihadistan could not have hoped for a softer target. Maybe we don't have a sense of the nation—or we are not angry enough. There are elections to be won, and communities to be indulged. A few mangled bodies on the busiest streets are an inevitable diversion for a political class that has already let India down, again and again. ■